

7. THEME DETECTION

In this type of questions, a paragraph is given followed by certain statements which may or may not be inferred from the passage. The candidate is required to choose that statement which contains the gist or the theme of the passage i.e., the idea that it conveys.

Example : Through advertising, manufacturing exercises a high degree of control over consumers' desires. However, the manufacturer assumes enormous risks in attempting to predict what consumers will want and in producing goods in quantity and distributing them in advance of final selection by the consumers. (8.B.I.P.O. 1995)

The paragraph best supports the statement that manufacturers —

- (a) distribute goods directly to the consumers.
- (b) can eliminate the risk of overproduction by advertising. >
- (c) always take moderate and calculated risk.
- (d) can predict with great accuracy the success of any product they put on the market.
- (e) must depend upon the final consumers for the success of their undertakings.

Solution : According to the passage, it is very difficult for the manufacturer to predict the consumers' response to his products. But by advertising, he can stimulate the consumers to buy his product. So, the theme of the paragraph is best mentioned in (d). Hence, **(d)** is the answer.

- (a) is incorrect because it is mentioned in the paragraph that manufacturers distribute goods in advance of their demands and not directly to the consumers.
- (b) is wrong because according to the passage, manufacturers take 'enormous' and not 'moderate' risks.
- (d) is wrong because it is mentioned in the passage that manufacturers take great risk in predicting what the consumers want,
- (e) is a true statement but it does not depict the complete theme of the passage.

EXERCISE 7

Directions : *Each of the following questions contains a small paragraph followed by a question on it. Read each paragraph carefully and answer the question given below it :*

1. The virtue of art does not allow the work to be interfered with or immediately ruled by anything other than itself. It insists that it alone shall touch the work in order to bring it into being. Art requires that nothing shall attain the work except through art itself. (Bank P.O. 1996)
, This passage best supports the statement that :
 - (a) art is governed by external rules and conditions.
 - (b) art is for the sake of art and life,
 - (c) art is for the sake of art alone.
 - (d) artist realises his dreams through his artistic creation.
 - (e) artist should use his art for the sake of society.

2. Though the waste of time or the expenditure on fashions is very large, yet fashions have come to stay. They will not go, come what may. However, what is now required is that strong efforts should be made to displace the excessive craze for fashion from the minds of these youngsters.

The passage best supports the statement that :

- (a) fashion is the need of the day.
 - (b) the excessive craze for fashion is detrimental to one's personality.
 - (c) the hoard for fashion should be done away with so as not to let down the constructive development
 - (d) work and other activities should be valued more than the outward appearance.
3. Due to enormous profits involved in smuggling, hundreds of persons have been attracted towards this anti-national activity. Some of them became millionaires overnight. India has a vast coastline both on the Eastern and Western Coast. It has been a heaven for smugglers who have been carrying on their activities with great impunity. There is no doubt, that from time to time certain seizures were made by the enforcement authorities, during raids and ambush but even allowing these losses the smugglers made huge profits.

The passage best supports the statement that :

- (a) smuggling hampers the economic development of a nation.
 - (b) smuggling ought to be curbed.
 - (c) authorities are taking strict measures to curb smuggling.
 - (d) smuggling is fast increasing in our country owing to the quick profit it entails.
4. The only true education comes through the stimulation of the child's powers by the demands of the social situations in which he finds himself. Through these demands he is stimulated to act as a member of a unity, to emerge from his original narrowness of action and feeling, and to conceive himself from the standpoint of the welfare of the group to which he belongs.

The passage best supports the statement that real education —

- (a) will take place if the children imbibe action and feeling.
 - (b) will take place if the children are physically strong,
 - (c) is not provided in our schools today.
 - (d) comes through the interaction with social situations.
 - (e) comes from the self-centred approach of the students. **(Bank P.O. 1996)**
5. Emerson said that the poet was landlord, seelord, airdom. The flight of imagination made the poet master of land, sea and air. But a poet's dream of yesterday becomes today an actual achievement and a reality for all men. Even those who invented, improved and perfected the aeroplane could hardly have dreamt of the possibility of flight into outer space.

The passage best supports the statement that :

- (a) seemingly impossible imaginations make one a good poet.
 - (b) all imaginations become a reality some day.
 - (c) what man imagined has never been impossible; he has always turned it a reality through his conception of ideas and sheer hard labour.
 - (d) man has reached the climax of technological development with his exploration into outer space.
6. The prevention of accidents makes it necessary not only that safety devices be used to guard exposed machinery but also that mechanics be instructed in safety

Hidden page

- (c) a nation's economy strengthens with the increase in exports.
- (d) English trade has continually increased since the Second World War.

10. Throughout the ages the businessman has helped build civilisation's great cities, provided people with luxuries and artists with patronage, and lift his fellow citizens to understand the standard of living. In the last few centuries the businessman has seeded the Industrial Revolution around the world.

The passage best supports the statement that the businessman —

- (a) is accountable to the society.
- (b) lives luxurious and comfortable life.**
- (c) is the beneficiary of the Industrial Revolution.
- (d) is capable of raising his standard of living.
- (e) has contributed to the growth of civilisation.

(S.B.I.P.O. 1995)

11. Industrial exhibitions play a major role in a country's economy. Such exhibitions, now regularly held in Delhi, enable us to measure the extent of our own less advanced industrial progress and the mighty industrial power and progress of countries like the U.K., U.S.A. and Russia whose pavilions are the centres of the greatest attention and attractions.

The passage best supports the statement that industrial exhibitions —

- (a) greatly tax the poor economies.
- (b) are more useful for the developed countries like U.S.A whose products stand out superior to those of the developing countries.**
- (c) are not of much use to the countries who are industrially backward.
- (d) boost up production qualitatively and quantitatively by analytical comparison of a country's products with those of the developed countries.

12. Satisfaction with co-workers, promotion opportunities, the nature of work, and pay goes with high performance among those with strong growth needs. Among those with weak growth needs, no such relationship is present — and, in fact, satisfaction with promotion opportunities goes with low performance.

This passage best supports the statement that :

- (a) satisfaction is an inevitable organisational variable.
- (b) job satisfaction and performance are directly and closely related.**
- (c) relationship between job satisfaction and performance is moderated by growth need.
- (d) **every** organisation has few employees having weak growth need.
- (e) high performance is essential for organisational effectiveness.

13. The attainment of individual and organisational goals is mutually interdependent⁶ and linked by a common denominator — employee work motivation. Organisational members are motivated to satisfy their personal goals, and they contribute their efforts to the attainment of organisational objectives as means of achieving these

¹ personal goals.

(S.B.I.P.O. 1995)

The passage best supports the statement that motivation —

- (a) encourages an individual to give priority to personal goals over organisational goals.
- (b) is crucial for the "survival of an individual and organisation**
- (c) is the product of an individual's physical and mental energy.

Hidden page

Hidden page